

SEGMENTATION + CONJOINT ANALYSIS

Kirin: Turning Customer Preferences into Product Strategy

A Conjoint- and Segmentation-Based Product Marketing Recommendation

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Marketing Analytics

MBA academic case study using Enginius-provided data. Analysis and recommendations are independently developed and do not represent work performed for or endorsed by Kirin.

Calorie and Origin Cues — Not Packaging — Should Anchor the Launch Decision

1

Business Question

Should Kirin launch a new beer, and which product profile and customer segment should it target to maximize preference and combined brand share?

2

Most Important Customer Insight

Calories (17.7%) and Origin (16.5%) drive more preference than any other attribute — nearly twice the weight of Glass style (10.5%). Yet the largest customer segment (51% of respondents) is occasion-driven, not taste-intensity driven.

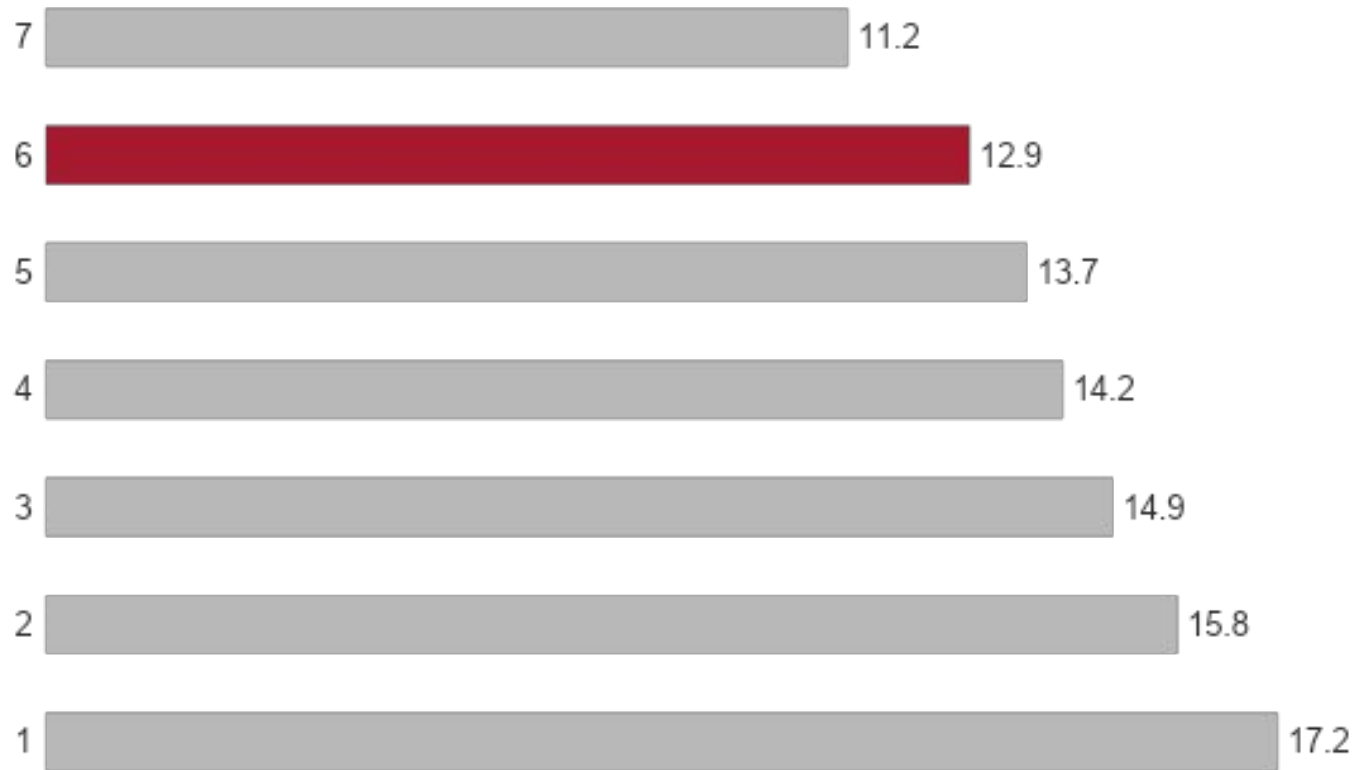
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Strategic Recommendation

Portfolio interpretation: lead positioning with calorie-conscious, Japanese-heritage cues and occasion-based messaging over packaging or glass redesign; re-test the concept's full-bodied recipe against the majority segment before committing resources.

BUSINESS PROBLEM

Kirin Sits Mid-Pack in a Crowded Import Beer Market



PMM question

Which customer segments and product attributes should guide product strategy and positioning?

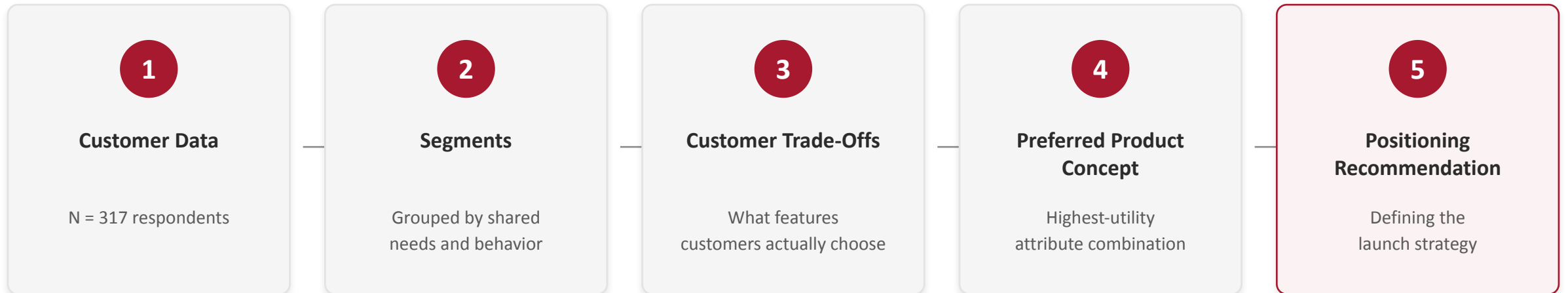
Why this matters

Kirin/Sapporo's baseline 12.9% share of preference is the number any new-product strategy has to beat — mid-pack, well behind Corona/Dos Equis/Tecate at 17.2%.

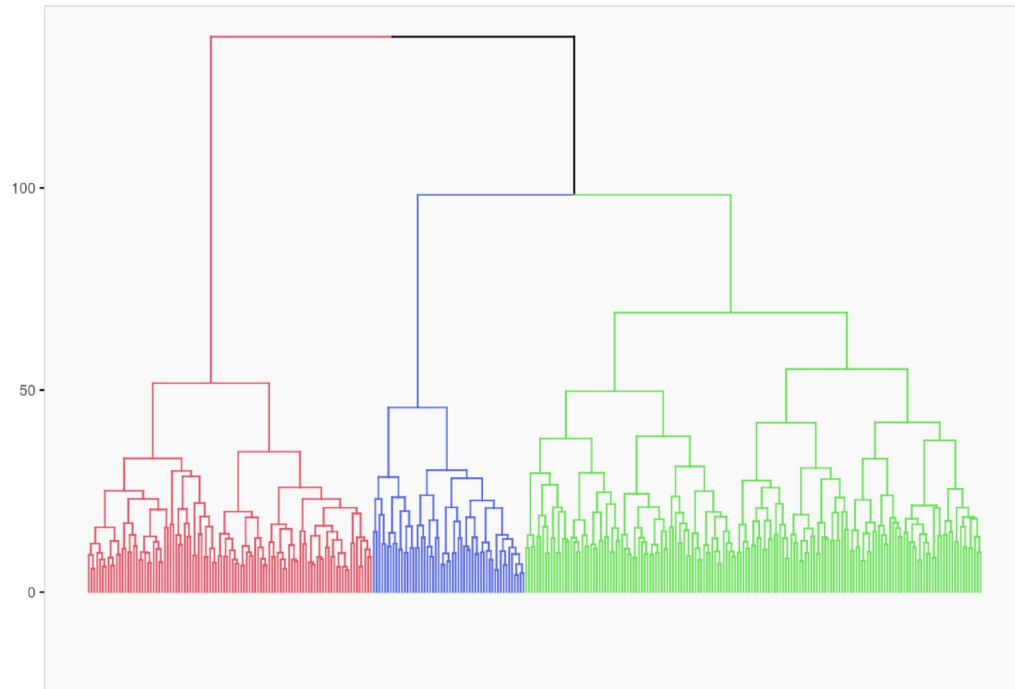
From Customer Data to a Positioning Decision

Segmentation groups customers with similar needs or preferences into distinct clusters.

Conjoint analysis measures the trade-offs customers make across product attributes and levels — more predictive of real choice than asking customers to rate features in isolation.



Three Segments Emerge — Only One Is Driven by Taste Intensity



Hierarchical clustering, 3-segment solution (N = 317)

A dendrogram groups respondents by similarity, read bottom (individuals) to top (one cluster). The height of a merge shows how different two groups are; cutting the tree at three branches balances statistical fit with targetability.

Beer Enthusiasts 32% · n = 101

Statistically higher than average on every attribute tested — especially good taste (8.3 vs. population 3.0) and high quality (7.5 vs. 4.5). Highly engaged across every drinking occasion.

Low-Involvement Drinkers 17% · n = 54

Statistically lower than average on every attribute tested. Indifferent to taste, quality, brand, and occasion — the lowest-priority segment for targeted messaging.

Occasion-Driven Drinkers 51% · n = 162, the majority

Not statistically different from average on most attributes, but scores lower on rich/full body and skews higher on social occasions — dining out, drinking with friends, serving guests.

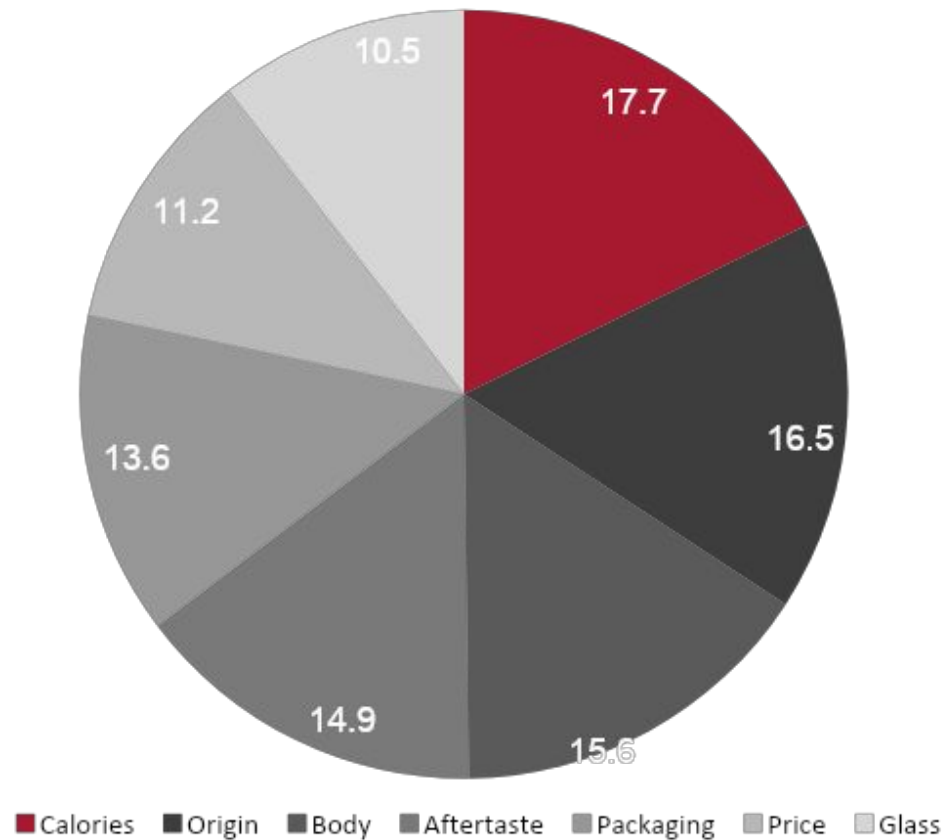
PMM implication: Different customer groups value different benefits, so targeting and messaging should not be one-size-fits-all.

Respondents Traded Off Seven Attributes, Not Just Price

317 respondents chose among product profiles built from these 7 attributes at 3 levels each (21 levels total) — including 7 existing competitors plus one new concept.

Attribute	Levels Tested	Business Question It Answers
Origin	European, Canadian, Japanese	The heritage/provenance cue customers weigh
Price	\$6.19, \$5.49, \$4.79	Price sensitivity and value perception
Body	Rich full-bodied, Regular body, Crisp and clear	The taste-intensity trade-off
Aftertaste	Strong, Mild, Very mild	Tolerance for lingering flavor
Calories	Full, Regular, Low	The health/wellness trade-off
Packaging	Six 12oz Large, Six 12oz Small, Four 16oz	Format and portion preference
Glass	Green Label, Brown Label, Brown Painted	Visual and shelf-presence preference

Calories and Origin Drove More Preference Than Any Other Attribute



17.7% of preference driven by Calories

16.5% of preference driven by Origin

Together, the top two attributes carry more weight than the bottom three (Price, Packaging, Glass) combined.

PMM implication

Product and messaging priority should follow this hierarchy: calorie and origin cues first. Glass and label style matter least (10.5%) and are not worth heavy investment.

The Tested Concept Trades Away Its Two Highest-Scoring Levels

Attribute	Top-Scoring Level (Score)	Kirin New Concept's Level	Match?
Origin	European (11.7)	Japanese	Mid-tier
Price	\$5.49 (6.5)	\$5.49	Top level ✓
Body	Rich full-bodied (11.0)	Rich full-bodied	Top level ✓
Aftertaste	Mild (12.5)	Very mild	Mid-tier
Calories	Low (10.2)	Regular	Lowest-scoring
Packaging	Six 12oz Large (10.4)	Six 12oz Small	Lowest-scoring
Glass	Brown Painted (7.6)	Brown Label	Mid-tier

The tested concept matches the top-scoring level on only two of seven attributes — Price and Body. It uses the lowest-scoring level for Calories and Packaging, and mid-tier levels for Origin, Aftertaste, and Glass. **Because Calories is the single most important attribute (17.7%), this is the trade-off most worth re-testing before finalizing the recipe.**

Strategic Recommendation Based on Academic-Case Findings

PORTFOLIO INTERPRETATION — *a hypothetical go-to-market recommendation derived from the analysis, not an actual Kirin business decision.*

Priority Segment

Beer Enthusiasts (32%): most responsive to taste/quality claims. Secondary emphasis on Occasion-Driven Drinkers (51%) via occasion-based messaging — they are the largest group even though less taste-driven.

Feature Emphasis

Prioritize calorie and origin/heritage cues over packaging or glass investment. Re-test a lighter-body variant against the majority segment, whose stated preference runs counter to the tested full-bodied recipe.

Positioning / Value Proposition

A Japanese-heritage, calorie-conscious, easy-drinking beer built for both taste enthusiasts and social occasions.

Suggested Launch Message

“Full flavor, lighter calories — Kirin, done right.” (illustrative, not a validated tagline)

Next validation step: Test the concept's full-bodied recipe against the Occasion-Driven segment specifically (51% of the market) before committing go-to-market resources — their stated preference runs counter to this attribute.

This Analysis Supports a Launch Decision, With Real Boundaries

Business Decision Enabled

In simulation, adding the tested concept lifts Kirin's combined family share of preference from a 12.9% baseline to 23.2% (+10.3 points). The existing Kirin/Sapporo line's own share also dips slightly (12.9% → 11.3%) — consistent with the modest share dilution every competitor experiences when a new option enters the choice set, not disproportionate self-cannibalization.

Skills Demonstrated

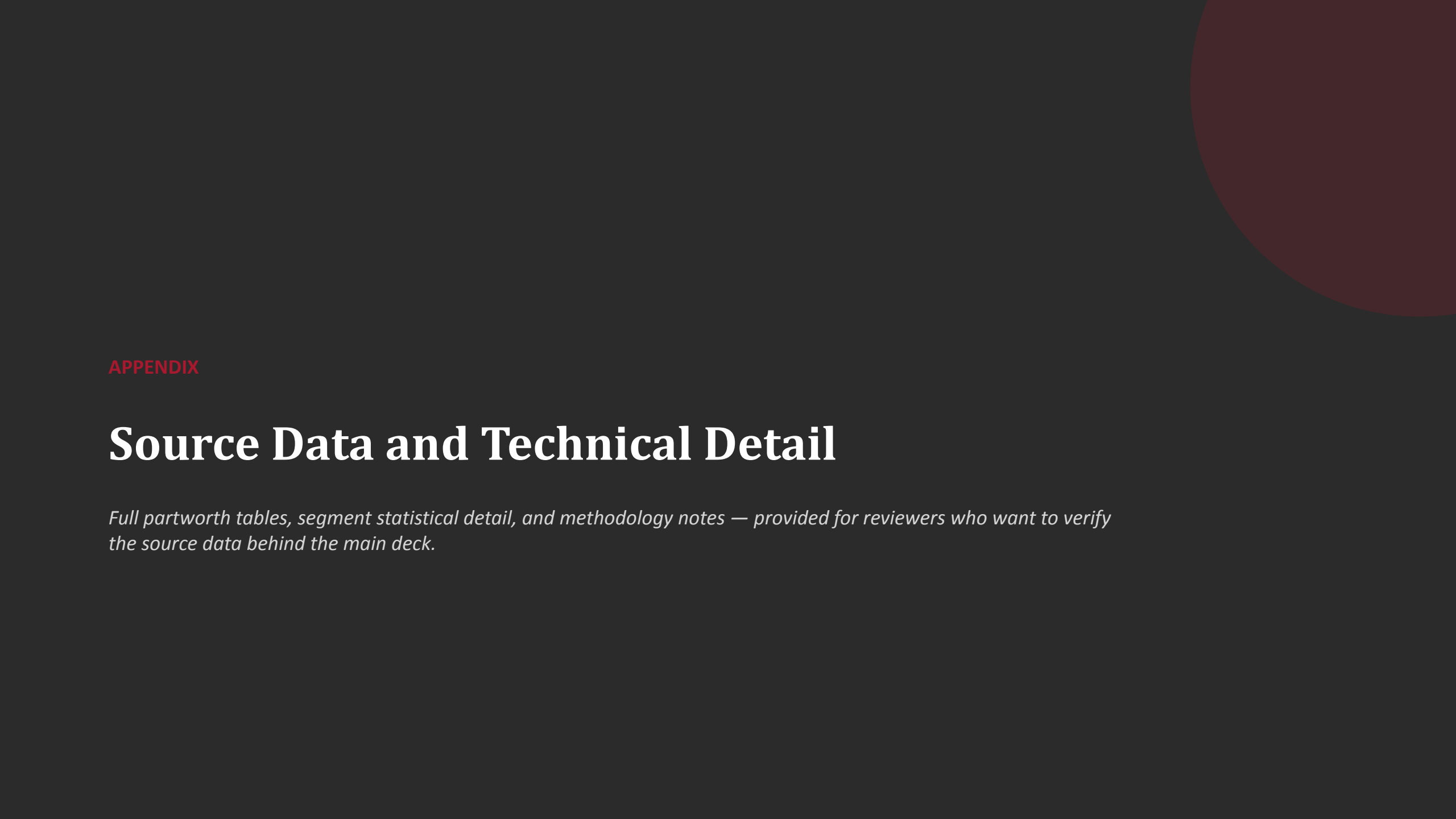
Customer insight extraction, segmentation interpretation, conjoint-analysis interpretation, feature prioritization, positioning, and strategic storytelling.

Limitations

Academic case study using Enginius-provided data; reflects stated preferences from a controlled exercise, not real purchase behavior. Segments could not be reliably predicted from demographics alone (classification hit rate: 51%, no better than always guessing the largest segment; no descriptor was statistically significant). Recommendations require real-market validation.

“I translate customer-preference evidence into product and go-to-market decisions.”

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APPENDIX

Source Data and Technical Detail

Full partworth tables, segment statistical detail, and methodology notes — provided for reviewers who want to verify the source data behind the main deck.

Source & Methodology Notes

- Two Enginius (DecisionPro Inc.) modules were used: a Conjoint Analysis report and a Segmentation report, both run on the same N = 317 respondent base.
- Conjoint: partworths provided as-is (not re-estimated); simulations use the share-of-preference decision rule; 7 attributes × 3 levels (21 levels total); 7 existing competitor profiles plus 1 new concept (“Kirin New”).
- Segmentation: hierarchical clustering, no standardization, 3-segment solution retained on statistical grounds (scree plot).
- A classification model tested whether demographic/psychographic descriptors (age, income, education, sex, consumption, personality items) could predict segment membership. Global hit rate was 51% — statistically no better than always predicting the largest segment (51% of respondents) — and no individual descriptor's p-value was below 0.05. Segments are behavioral, not demographic.
- All figures in this deck are taken directly from the Enginius PDF output. No market data, sample sizes, revenue, or business outcomes were invented or estimated outside the source reports.

Full Attribute-Level Preference Partworths (1 of 2)

Attribute	Level	Average	Std. Dev.	Min	Max
Origin	European	11.7	8.9	0.0	42.0
Origin	Canadian	4.9	7.8	0.0	32.0
Origin	Japanese	8.8	8.1	0.0	36.0
Price	\$6.19	4.2	6.1	0.0	34.0
Price	\$5.49	6.5	6.8	0.0	38.0
Price	\$4.79	6.2	7.6	0.0	51.0
Body	Rich full bodied	11.0	11.3	0.0	49.0
Body	Regular body	1.8	4.0	0.0	30.0
Body	Crisp and clear	9.6	6.7	0.0	31.0
Aftertaste	Strong	3.6	6.0	0.0	29.0
Aftertaste	Mild	12.5	8.5	0.0	44.0
Aftertaste	Very mild	5.9	6.1	0.0	31.0

Source: Kirin MBA academic case analysis using Enginius-provided data (Conjoint: Summary — average preference partworths).

Full Attribute-Level Preference Partworths (2 of 2)

Attribute	Level	Average	Std. Dev.	Min	Max
Calories	Full	8.4	9.5	0.0	37.0
Calories	Regular	6.7	8.4	0.0	35.0
Calories	Low	10.2	9.7	0.0	45.0
Packaging	Six 12Oz Large	10.4	7.5	0.0	37.0
Packaging	Six 12Oz Small	2.6	5.0	0.0	31.0
Packaging	Four 16Oz	6.9	6.4	0.0	36.0
Glass	Green Label	3.3	5.1	0.0	30.0
Glass	Brown Label	5.6	6.3	0.0	29.0
Glass	Brown Painted	7.6	7.3	0.0	32.0

Source: Kirin MBA academic case analysis using Enginius-provided data (Conjoint: Summary — average preference partworths).

Segment Statistical Profile (Centroid Averages) (1 of 2)

Bold values are statistically different from the rest of the population ($p<.05$). Segment 1 = Beer Enthusiasts (32%); Segment 2 = Low-Involvement Drinkers (17%); Segment 3 = Occasion-Driven Drinkers (51%).

Segmentation Variable	Population	Segment 1 (32%)	Segment 2 (17%)	Segment 3 (51%)
Rich full-bodied	4.77	7.41	2.76	3.79
Light beer	3.72	4.11	3.48	3.56
No aftertaste	4.56	5.56	2.93	4.48
Refreshing	5.02	7.06	1.57	4.90
Goes down easily	5.17	6.58	2.63	5.13
Gives a buzz	3.39	3.79	2.63	3.40
Good taste	3.00	8.35	0.11	0.63
Low price	3.91	4.67	2.96	3.75
Good value	4.65	5.72	2.74	4.62
From country w/ brewing tradition	3.82	4.30	2.26	4.04

Green = statistically higher than population average; red = statistically lower ($p<.05$). Source: Enginius Segmentation report, Segment description / Segment differences per segment.

Segment Statistical Profile (Centroid Averages) (2 of 2)

Segmentation Variable	Population	Segment 1 (32%)	Segment 2 (17%)	Segment 3 (51%)
Attractive bottle	3.00	3.22	2.39	3.06
Prestigious brand	3.20	3.84	1.94	3.22
High quality	4.48	7.47	1.94	3.46
Drink at picnics	4.56	5.22	1.63	5.14
Masculine	2.67	3.34	2.00	2.48
For young people	2.49	3.07	1.94	2.31
Drink with friends	4.70	5.71	0.89	5.33
Drink at home	4.34	5.90	1.61	4.27
To serve dinner guests	4.92	6.40	1.20	5.23
For dining out	5.03	6.24	1.37	5.50
Drink at bar	4.35	5.34	1.17	4.79

Green = statistically higher than population average; red = statistically lower (p<.05). Source: Enginius Segmentation report, Segment description / Segment differences per segment.